THREE COMPANIES · ONE PLATFORM

ERGO Connect

Platform Overview & Demo Guide

Who does what, and how a part moves from first enquiry to delivered order.

ERGO | CUSTOMER | SUPPLIER

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1. What ERGO Connect Is

ERGO Connect is a single, shared system that replaces scattered emails, spreadsheets and phone calls with one tracked pipeline connecting three parties: **ERGO**'s own teams, ERGO's **customers**, and ERGO's **suppliers**. A part's entire life — from a customer's first enquiry, through pricing, development, production, and quality, to final delivery — happens inside one record that the right people can see at the right time, and nobody else.

Two ideas sit underneath everything else in the system, and are worth saying out loud before any demo:

- **Every record has a role check and a company check.** A user's role decides which actions are even possible (view / create / edit / submit / approve); their company decides which records they can reach at all. Both are enforced by the system itself — not just hidden in the screen design.
- **Commercially sensitive information is compartmentalised by design.** Suppliers never see the customer, customers never see competing suppliers or ERGO's margins, and nobody sees another company's data — full stop.

The pipeline, in one line:

RFQ → Quotation → NPD → OFP (production) → Quality → Delivery & Closure

2. Glossary — terms used throughout this guide

Term	Meaning
RFQ	Request for Quotation — a customer's part/project requirement sent in for pricing.
NPD	New Product Development — the pre-production phase: tooling, trials, sample approval.
OFP	Order Fulfilment & Production — live order tracking from material to dispatch to delivery.
NCR	Non-Conformance Report — a formal record raised when something fails to meet spec.
CAPA	Corrective & Preventive Action — the fix and the prevention plan tied to an NCR.
KAM	Key Account Manager — the single point of coordination for one customer or supplier account.
PPAP	Production Part Approval Process — the formal sign-off that a part is ready for production.
MOQ	Minimum Order Quantity.
Dispatch gate	The rule that a quality inspection must pass before an order can leave the factory.

3. Who's In The System — 18 Roles, 3 Organisations

Every login belongs to exactly one company and carries exactly one active role at a time (a person can hold more than one role and switch between them, but never acts as two at once). Below is every role, grouped by organisation, with what they can see, what they typically do, and — often the most useful line for a demo — one thing they are explicitly blocked from.

3.1 ERGO — Internal Teams (7 roles)

ERGO's own staff. Most roles here own one stage of the pipeline end to end; Admin and Management see everything, and the KAM coordinates across stages for their assigned accounts only.

ERGO Admin

Full system administrator.

Sees: Every company, every record, every audit log — system-wide.

Does: Creates logins, assigns company + role, resets passwords, manages master data and policies. Can override locks and reopen records where policy allows.

Can't: Is the only role that can create a user or assign a role — everyone else only views users in their own scope.

ERGO Management

Executive oversight across the whole business.

Sees: Every module, every company — view and configured approvals.

Does: Reviews dashboards and monitors performance. Approves high-value or high-risk decisions where an approval matrix requires it.

Can't: Does not do day-to-day data entry — by design, routine transactions are not an Executive's job.

ERGO Key Account Manager

Single coordination point for a set of customer accounts.

Sees: Only the customer accounts assigned to them, plus the suppliers linked to those projects.

Does: Reviews progress across RFQ / NPD / OFP / Quality / Documents / Communication for their accounts. Escalates and coordinates between customer, ERGO, and supplier.

Can't: Cannot see or act on any account that isn't assigned to them, and mostly views rather than approves.

ERGO RFQ

Runs the commercial pipeline from enquiry to customer decision.

Sees: All RFQs and quotes company-wide.

Does: Validates incoming RFQs, floats them to chosen suppliers, compares every supplier's quote side by side. Decides — case by case — whether the customer sees one supplier's quote as-is or an ERGO-blended quote, and sends it.

Can't: Has no visibility into OFP or Quality modules — their ownership ends once a quote is decided.

ERGO NPD

Owns the pre-production development project.

Sees: All NPD projects company-wide.

Does: Manually converts an approved RFQ into an NPD project and runs it through its stage gates. Coordinates supplier development tasks and customer-facing milestones, then hands the finished project to OFP.

Can't: Cannot start a project on an RFQ nobody approved, and cannot see live production orders until they hand over.

ERGO OFP

Owns the live order from material to delivery.

Sees: All production orders company-wide.

Does: Tracks material, production, packaging, dispatch and shipment status. Coordinates supplier, quality and customer on live commitments.

Can't: Cannot mark an order dispatch-ready until Quality's inspection on that order has actually passed.

ERGO Quality

Owns inspection, non-conformance and deviation control.

Sees: All quality records company-wide.

Does: Runs inspections, NCRs, CAPA and deviation approvals. Is the gate both NPD's final-sample closure and OFP's dispatch check before they can proceed.

Can't: Doesn't perform the dispatch or stage-close action itself — only decides the inspection result those actions check.

3.2 Customer — Roles (6 roles)

Every customer role is locked to that one company's own records. Across RFQ and NPD alike, the identity of the supplier working on their part is never exposed to them.

Customer RFQ

Raises and tracks their own company's RFQs.

Sees: Only their own company's records.

Does: Creates RFQs, uploads drawings/specs. Approves, declines, or requests revision on the quote ERGO shares with them.

Can't: Never sees which supplier is quoting, any other supplier's price, or any other customer's data.

Customer NPD

Tracks development progress on their own project.

Sees: Only their own company's NPD projects.

Does: Reviews sample status and milestones. Acknowledges milestones and approves customer-facing sample records.

Can't: Never sees which supplier is developing their part — the same anonymity rule as RFQ carries into NPD.

Customer OFP

Tracks their own order's fulfilment.

Sees: Only their own company's orders.

Does: Views production, dispatch, and shipment progress.

Can't: Has no visibility into supplier-side commercial detail or any competitor's order.

Customer Quality

Handles customer-side quality sign-off.

Sees: Only their own company's quality records.

Does: Reviews complaints and customer-facing quality records. Approves or rejects items that explicitly require customer acceptance (e.g. a deviation).

Can't: Cannot see supplier-side NCR/CAPA detail that isn't customer-facing.

Customer Key Account Manager

Full-account coordinator on the customer side.

Sees: Full visibility across RFQ / NPD / OFP / Quality / Documents / Communication for their own company only.

Does: Acts as the escalation owner for their company.

Can't: Never sees another customer's account, under any circumstance.

Customer Management

Optional supervisory role above the functional customer roles.

Sees: Same scope as Customer KAM — own company only.

Does: Available if a specific customer wants a supervisory user above their functional team.

Can't: Seeded inactive by default — only turned on if a client specifically asks for it.

3.3 Supplier — Roles (5 roles)

Every supplier role is locked to that one company's own assigned work. The identity of the customer behind an RFQ or NPD project is never exposed to them, and they are never told in-portal whether they won or lost a quote.

Supplier RFQ

Quotes on the RFQs ERGO assigns to them.

Sees: Only RFQs assigned to their own company.

Does: Submits quotations, raises clarification requests, or regrets an RFQ with a reason. Can only edit a submitted quote when ERGO explicitly re-opens it.

Can't: Never sees who the customer is, any competitor's quote, the target price, or whether they won or lost.

Supplier NPD

Executes their own development tasks.

Sees: Only NPD projects assigned to their own company.

Does: Updates task readiness, attachments, process confirmations, and issue responses.

Can't: Never sees the customer behind the project, or any project not assigned to them.

Supplier OFP

Runs production on their assigned orders.

Sees: Only orders assigned to their own company.

Does: Updates production status, quantities, dispatch readiness, and blocker reasons.

Can't: Cannot mark anything dispatch-ready past ERGO Quality's inspection gate.

Supplier Quality

Responds to quality findings on their own work.

Sees: Only quality records linked to their own company.

Does: Responds to inspections, NCRs and CAPA; uploads supporting quality documents.

Can't: Cannot approve final customer-side quality closure unless specifically configured to.

Supplier Key Account Manager

Full-account coordinator on the supplier side.

Sees: Full visibility across RFQ / NPD / OFP / Quality / Documents / Communication for their own company only.

Does: Acts as the commercial/coordination owner for their company.

Can't: Never sees another supplier's account, or the customer's identity.

4. How A Record Moves, Stage By Stage

This is the walkthrough to actually demo: follow one part from enquiry to delivery, showing the handoff between ERGO, the customer and the supplier at each stage.

1. RFQ — enquiry to a decided quote

- A Customer RFQ user (or ERGO RFQ, on the customer's behalf) raises the RFQ with drawings, technical specs and commercial requirements.
- ERGO RFQ reviews and validates it, then floats it to one or more chosen suppliers. **Suppliers never see which customer the RFQ is for.**
- Each assigned Supplier RFQ submits a quote (or regrets it with a reason). Once submitted, a quote is locked — ERGO must explicitly re-open it for the supplier to revise, and every re-open keeps the old version on file.
- ERGO RFQ compares every supplier's quote side by side. No customer or supplier ever sees another party's quote, cost breakdown, or ERGO's internal notes.
- ERGO RFQ decides, each time, what the customer actually receives: one supplier's quote as-is, or an ERGO-blended quote that hides the supplier and the margin — then sends it. Only one quote is ever in flight to the customer at a time.
- Customer RFQ reviews only that ERGO-selected quote and Approves, Declines, or Requests Revision (a comment is required for the latter two).
- Approval does not do anything automatically — the project simply appears in ERGO NPD's “ready for conversion” queue. Suppliers are never told in the portal whether they were selected.

2. NPD — turning an approved quote into a producible part

- ERGO NPD manually pulls an approved RFQ from the queue and converts it into an NPD project (one approved RFQ becomes at most one NPD project).
- **The customer and the supplier are still never shown to each other** — the RFQ-phase anonymity rule carries all the way through NPD.
- The project runs through nine stages: Planning → Commercial & Sourcing Readiness → Tooling & Material Release → Trial Preparation → Trial Execution → Final Sample Readiness → Customer Feedback → Approved for Production Handover → Closed.
- ERGO NPD runs the activity checklist for each stage; a stage cannot close until its mandatory activities are done. Supplier NPD updates their own tasks, attachments and readiness as they go.
- Customer NPD is only looped in at the stages that need them — sample feedback and milestone acknowledgment — not every stage.
- Before Final Sample Readiness can close, the system checks ERGO Quality's most recent inspection result on that project — a later passing re-inspection can clear an earlier rejection without anyone needing to overwrite the rejected record.
- ERGO NPD performs one explicit “handover” action that creates the production order in OFP — nothing moves to production silently or automatically.

3. OFP — the live production order

- The order moves through: Order Created → Material Ordered → Material Received → Production Started → In Inspection → Packaging in Progress → Dispatch Ready → Dispatched → In Transit → Delivered → Closed, with an On Hold / Blocked state that always requires a reason.
- ERGO OFP owns the order end to end; Supplier OFP updates production status, quantities, dispatch readiness and blockers only for the orders assigned to them.
- **Dispatch cannot be marked ready until the order's linked quality inspection has actually passed** (or passed with a documented deviation) — this is enforced in the workflow itself, not left to a checkbox.

- Customer OFP sees read-only progress, dispatch and shipment status for their own orders only — never supplier-side commercial detail.
- Delivery confirmation moves the order to Closed.

4. Quality — runs alongside NPD and OFP, not after them

- Three parallel workflows: **Inspection** (Open → In Inspection → Passed / Rejected / Released with Deviation → Closed), **NCR** — Non-Conformance Report — (Open → Containment → Root Cause → CAPA → Pending Closure Approval → Closed), and **Deviation** (Requested → Under Review → optional Customer Approval → Approved / Rejected → Closed).
- ERGO Quality owns all three and is the gate both NPD (final sample) and OFP (dispatch) check before they can move forward.
- Supplier Quality responds on their own linked inspection items, NCRs and CAPA.
- Customer Quality only sees and acts on the customer-facing slice — complaints, sample approvals, and any closure explicitly flagged as needing customer sign-off.

5. Delivery & Closure

- Delivery and final closure happen inside OFP (Delivered → Closed) once dispatch, shipment tracking and any post-delivery quality items are resolved.
- Documents (versioned drawings, quotes, CAPA evidence, proof-of-delivery) and threaded Communication sit underneath every stage above, with the same company-scoped visibility rules as the rest of the system — this layer is what's being built right now (see Build Status).

5. Quick Reference — Who's Active At Each Stage

Role	RFQ	Quotation	NPD	OFP	Quality
ERGO Admin	O	O	O	O	O
ERGO Management	O	O	O	O	O
ERGO Key Account Manager	A	V	V	V	V
ERGO RFQ	O	O	V	-	-
ERGO NPD	V	V	O	V	V
ERGO OFP	-	-	V	O	A
ERGO Quality	-	-	A	A	O
Customer RFQ	A	A	V	-	-
Customer NPD	-	-	A	V	V
Customer OFP	-	-	-	V	V
Customer Quality	-	-	A	V	A
Customer Key Account Manager	A	A	V	V	V
Customer Management	A	A	V	V	V
Supplier RFQ	A	A	-	-	-
Supplier NPD	-	-	A	A	V
Supplier OFP	-	-	A	A	V
Supplier Quality	-	-	A	A	A
Supplier Key Account Manager	A	A	A	A	V

O = Owns / gives final approval A = Acts — creates, edits or submits, but doesn't give final approval V = Views only – = No access

6. What's Live Today vs. What's Coming

Set expectations before the demo: everything in the walkthrough above is built and under automated test except the Documents/Communication layer, which is mid-build.

Built and working today

- Foundations: database, security baseline, audit infrastructure
- Login, roles, one-active-role-per-session, company scoping, full audit trail
- Master data, and customer / supplier management with an approval workflow for new companies
- RFQ: creation, supplier float, supplier quoting, quote comparison, the customer decision
- NPD: ERGO-only conversion queue, the 9-stage workflow, and supplier/customer participation in it
- OFP: order core, production tracking, supplier participation, packaging & dispatch, shipments, customer read access, and order closure — full working frontend
- Quality: inspections, NCR/CAPA, deviations — and these are wired in as real, enforced gates on NPD stage-close and OFP dispatch, not placeholder fields

Being built right now

- Documents module backend — versioned, categorized files with lock/approval control (being built today)

Not yet built — don't demo or promise these

- Document Library / Detail screens, and the Communication Center (threaded comments per record)
- Notifications (an engine that reacts to everything already happening above)
- Dashboards — including the Quality dashboard, deliberately held until after Documents & Communication so it isn't rebuilt twice
- Production hardening: real cloud file storage + virus scanning, production-grade rate limiting, deployment